Ricardo Gaona

Software Engineer with 5+ years of experience

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github.com/ricardogaona

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full-Stack Software Engineer with 5 years of experience building and maintaining production applications used by a broad user base across industries such as fitness, legal services, and education. Proficient in Django, React, Next.js, and React Native, with experience delivering web and mobile applications from requirements definition through production release. Focused on understanding how a feature fits into the product and supports its goals before determining the most appropriate technical approach. Experienced in working with cross-functional teams, collaborating with Product and Design to deliver features that address user needs.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript
Frontend: React, Next.js, React Native, Expo, Redux
Backend & APIs: Django, Django REST Framework, NestJS, Node.js, Koa, REST APIs, GraphQL, Prisma
Databases & Async Systems: PostgreSQL, Redis, Celery
Tools & Practices: Git, GitHub, GitHub Actions, Cursor, Spec-driven development, AI-assisted development, CI/CD, Postman, Jira, Figma

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

WILLDOM / CODIUM — SOFTWARE ENGINEER (CONTRACTOR) **Jun 2021 – Present**
Remote
Develop and maintain production software for international and regional clients, contributing across frontend applications, backend APIs, databases, integrations, asynchronous workflows, and deployment pipelines.

SWORD SWEEPER — ALLOY & RELAY

Alloy - Full Stack Engineer Jan 2026 – Oct 2026

- Troubleshot and resolved high-impact production issues affecting M-Files contact synchronization, allowing users to create and synchronize contacts reliably.
- Planned and implemented an integration between M-Files and Alloy workflows, automatically updating Alloy workflow statuses and completing related tasks when M-Files workflows reached their final state, reducing manual work for users.
- Designed and implemented an automated duplicate-contact detection background task using Celery and Redis, enabling users to review potential duplicates and make informed decisions about merging or deleting records.

Relay - Full Stack Engineer Jan 2026 – Oct 2026

- Refactored the notification architecture using the Strategy Pattern to support multiple delivery channels, including SMS, in-app, and email, simplifying the implementation of new notifications and accelerating feature delivery.
- Introduced a ReferralGroup model to restructure the relationship between cases and referrals, allowing law firms to view and manage all the referrals of a case on a single page.
- Refactored address creation and update logic by moving complex business logic from the frontend to the backend, improving frontend maintainability.

Technology: TypeScript, React, Python, Django, Django REST Framework, PostgreSQL, Celery, Redis, REST APIs

PVOLVE

Software Engineer Jan 2025 – Dec 2025

- Led the development of a custom Next.js acquisition widget for marketing landing pages, overcoming the UI limitations of Mariana Tek's existing widget while continuing to use its backend services.
- Integrated Meta and Google Analytics into the customer acquisition widget to track user interactions, allowing the company to identify where users dropped off and decide which parts of the acquisition flow needed improvement.
- Migrated the streaming application's authentication module from Gatsby to Next.js as part of the team's effort to replace the legacy application.

Technology: Next.js, TypeScript, React, JavaScript, Shopify, Meta Pixel, Google Analytics, Jira

LEARNING THROUGH ART — BOOKS ALIVE FOR KIDS

Full Stack Engineer Aug 2023 – Present

- Optimized book asset downloads by bundling assets into a single compressed ZIP file instead of downloading them separately, reducing download times and improving the user experience.
- Developed an analytics dashboard using Django and React, allowing the organization to identify activities that took children longer to complete and understand where they might be struggling.
- Built a Book Manager portal using React to replace the complex process of setting up new books through Django Admin, making it easier for the organization to manage book content.

Technology: Django, React, Python, TypeScript, React Native

SOUTH ATLANTIC PACKAGING

Full Stack Engineer Feb 2023 – Jul 2024

- Built a bulk job update feature using Next.js and GraphQL, allowing supervisors to update multiple jobs at once instead of having to edit each job separately.
- Implemented a Sales role that restricted access to customers, items, jobs, and reports, ensuring sales users could only see information related to their assigned customers.
- Developed a feature that allowed users to save and reuse filters across jobs and reports, so they didn't have to configure the same filters every time they needed to find information.
- Built a PTO and holiday management feature that allowed users to create and update requests, approve or reject them, and access summary reports to keep track of requests.

Technology: Next.js, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, Hasura, GraphQL, GitHub Actions

EDUCATION

National University of Asunción Feb 2018 – Dec 2022
Software Engineering